

Similarities and Differences in Civil Peace and The Fly

- War victims

- War victims
- Grieving fathers
- Loss and Trauma
- Africa: east, poverty, struggle for survival; loss
- Europe: west, wealth, emotional trauma

CO_2 2 ppm ; 0.00002 %
 N_2 80,000 ppm N_2
 340 W/m²
 2500

Plot and Style in "Civil Peace"

- Notice the beginning: "Jonathan Iwegbu counted himself extra-ordinarily lucky. 'Happy survival!'"
- The sentence sets the tone of the narrative that follows
- Imagine a different beginning: the robbery, for example, or the rubble of buildings around Jonathan's house. Notice how the tone would have changed
- Unfolding of the narrative: the bicycle; "his little house in Ogui Overside"; repairing the house; family getting into business (children selling mangoes, wife selling akara balls), and so on
- All these events/data sets move us toward the possible high point (here material gain) of the narrative
- The high point amidst dire poverty: "the windfall" or the exgratia (egg-rasher)
- Iwegbu's caution and joy: foretell the possibility of another mishap
- The Robbery, the family's reaction: very human, very vulnerable
- The morning after, and the stoicism of the family/unmoved and steadfast. Back to business
- Repetition of the phrase "Nothing puzzles God!"
- And finally, the title of the story; emphasis on the irony; emphasis on the heroism of the natives

HDMI3

Written Communication: Mansfield's "The Fly"

Device: LNC_04
IP: 192.168.0.200
MAC: B1C0 7A1D
SSID: PWD: 12345678

Plot in "The Fly"

- Starting with Woodifield and the boss "snug" in the boss' parlor
- The boss is proud, successful, healthy; but alone. Woodifield has a family is poor
- The contrast is set; but the similarity too. Both are grieving fathers of sons lost to conscription
- We hear of the boss' love for his son much later. In the beginning, we cannot imagine him a grieving father
- Then we wait to see him grieve
- Instead, he watches a fly, is deeply cruel, kills the fly
- Plot ends with him forgetting his trauma; he is numbed
- The story addresses the loss of human emotions due to the war